

DA ONLY — RELIC SHEET

RELIC SHEET — THE CRUCIFIX OF ST. VITUS

DESIGNATION	The Crucifix of St. Vitus (a.k.a. The Martinice Crucifix, The Defenestration Relic)
TIER	2 — Threatening (2 Corruption per activation attempt)
FORM	Iron crucifix, approximately 14 cm × 7 cm. Dark patina, heavy for its size. No visible markings, inscriptions, or maker's marks. Simple Latin cross form. The iron is cold to the touch regardless of ambient temperature.
ARTIFACT DIE	d10 — Established artifact with centuries of documented history. The iron is ancient but the form is medieval; the object has been inactive for most of its existence (displayed, not worn).
RISK TAG	Volatile — Activation behavior is partly understood. Repeated use escalates psychological side effects. Misuse (attempting to "test" invincibility in increasingly dangerous ways) is the primary hazard.
CORRUPTION EMISSION	Aura — +1 Corruption at scene start for the wearer and any character sharing the same zone. The iron leaks ambient Corruption while worn. This is how the Covenant detected it in Vienna.

ORIGIN

The iron was smelted from a meteorite that struck the Bohemian Forest (modern Šumava region) around 900 CE. The impact was witnessed by a Slavic pagan community who built a shrine at the site, believing the iron to be a fragment of Perun's armor — the sky-god. When Christianity arrived in the region (10th–11th centuries), the shrine was demolished and the iron was reforged into a crucifix by unknown hands. The pagan origin was deliberately suppressed and replaced with a hagiographic narrative attributing the object to St. Vitus.

The crucifix passed into the Martinice family in the 14th or 15th century, likely through a marriage alliance with a Bohemian noble house that had acquired it during the shrine's destruction. The family treated it as a protective heirloom without understanding its origin. Count Jaroslav Bořita of Martinice was wearing it during the 1618 Defenestration of Prague — the crucifix rendered his 17-meter fall survivable.

The last Countess Martinice donated the crucifix to Prague Castle in 1952 under pressure from the communist government. It was displayed as a minor historical

curiosity until its theft six weeks before the case begins.

ACTIVATION

Activation Condition

The crucifix must be worn against bare skin — typically on a chain or cord around the neck, though any direct skin contact activates the effect. It does not require a verbal component, ritual, or blood offering. The effect is *passive*: simply wearing the crucifix renders the bearer immune to bodily harm.

Mechanical Effect

Immunity to Bodily Harm: The wearer cannot suffer physical damage from any source — bullets, blades, falls, fire, explosions, blunt trauma. The crucifix negates *all* Physical (STR) and Hobbling (AGI) damage. The wearer still feels pain, still registers impact, and still experiences the psychological effects of violence — they simply are not injured. Wounds do not appear. Bones do not break. The body remains in exactly the state it was in when the crucifix was first donned.

Limitations: The crucifix does not prevent death from drowning, suffocation, poison, disease, starvation, or old age. It does not heal pre-existing injuries — it only prevents new physical harm. It does not protect against Mental (WIT) or Emotional (EMP) damage. It does not protect against Corruption gain.

Corruption Cost: The wearer gains +1 **Corruption per scene** while wearing the crucifix (Aura emission, as above). This is in addition to any Corruption gained from pushing rolls or other sources.

Immortality Mania: After 7 consecutive days of wear, the bearer must make a **Psychoanalyze (EMP) roll at Difficulty 1**. On failure, they develop a compulsion to test the limits of their invincibility. The DA should escalate this gradually: minor risk-taking on Day 8, reckless behavior by Day 5, actively seeking life-threatening situations by Day 2. A successful Psychoanalyze roll at Difficulty 3 resets the mania for 24 hours.

Artifact Die Roll

After any scene in which the bearer would have taken damage (regardless of the crucifix negating it), roll the Artifact Die (d10):

- **1:** Die steps down (d10 → d8 → d6 → d4 → Fractured).
- **2+:** No change.

FRACTURE CONDITION

When the Artifact Die steps down past d4: the iron *cracks*. A hairline fracture appears diagonally across the crucifix. The immunity effect ends immediately. All damage the bearer *would have* taken during the period of wear manifests simultaneously — every bullet, every fall, every blow. The bearer is almost certainly killed instantly.

The fracture also triggers a **Corruption Burst**: all characters within Short range gain +3 Corruption as the accumulated harm discharges. The iron remains physically intact (the crack is metaphysical, not structural) but the artifact is inert — no further activation possible.

CONTAINMENT PROFILE

Quiescence Condition: The crucifix is inert when not worn against skin. Standard storage — a lead-lined containment box, a vault drawer, or even a locked desk — is sufficient to prevent activation.

Inadvertent Activation Risk: Moderate. Anyone who handles the crucifix and places it against their skin (even briefly, even accidentally) activates the effect. The activation is not obvious — the wearer may not realize they are protected until they survive something unsurvivable. Covenant handlers must wear gloves and store the crucifix in a container that prevents accidental skin contact.

Containment Procedure: Remove from bearer's person (bearer must be unconscious, restrained, or persuaded — physical force will not work). Place in a sealed lead-lined container. Transport to nearest Keep vault. Log under Tier 2 protocol. Do not under any circumstances attempt to test the effect — the

Corruption cost and mania risk make controlled testing unethical and operationally dangerous.

CONTAINMENT TRUTHS

Three facts must be discovered before the artifact can be safely contained:

CT-1: The Crucifix Is Pagan, Not Christian. The iron is meteoric. The effect is material, not divine. This truth is necessary to understand why the Church's interest is dangerous — they want to claim it as proof of miracle, which would trigger a theological crisis if the origin becomes public. *Sources: Countess Martinice's letters (L2, NPC2), Bohemian Forest shrine site (L6), Covenant archive analysis (HQ Fallback: Day 8).*

CT-2: The Bearer Can Be Contained by Non-Violent Means. The crucifix prevents physical harm, not restraint. The bearer can be grappled, sedated, handcuffed, or trapped. Violence will not work; ingenuity will. *Sources: Vienna test site analysis (L3), Covenant psychoanalytic consultation (HQ Fallback: Day 7), observing the thief's behavior (L4, NPC3).*

CT-3: The Shrine Site Contains Additional Fragments. The meteorite was not a single piece. More meteoric iron remains at the pagan shrine site in the Bohemian Forest. If harvested, additional objects could be forged with the same immortality property — making this a replicable threat requiring site-level containment. *Sources: Countess Martinice's family tree (L2, NPC2), shrine site excavation (L6), historical records of the Slavic pagan community (NPC5, Father Tomas).*

Relic Sheet — Case File: The Heavenly Crucifix. For DA use only. Do not share with players.